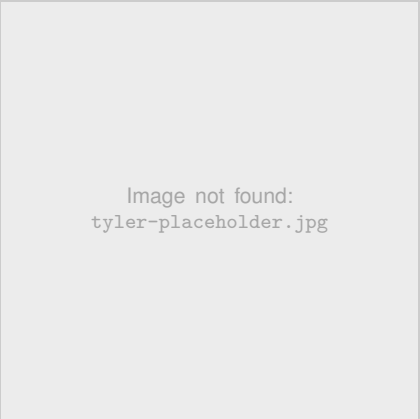
USER PERSONA: TYLER DURDEN



"If the university portal crashes while I am on hold with Centrelink and trying to sort out Mum's NDIS plan, my entire week's schedule completely collapses."

Age:	26
Gender:	Non-binary (They/Them)
Location:	Melbourne, Australia
Education:	Part-time B.Sc (Honours), High Distinction
Status:	NDIS Participant, Centrelink, Carer
Work:	PT Retail & Advocacy Spokesperson
Neurotype:	Autistic / ADHD
Energy:	Exhausted (Low/Fluctuating)

FREQUENCY
Scheduled Bursts (highly dependent on daily capacity)

MOTIVATION
Academic survival and pushing systemic change

SETTING
Home office, hospital waiting rooms, or commuting on public transport

LIFE EVENTS
2022: Diagnosed with burnout.
2023: Became full-time carer.
2024: Started Honours project.

GOALS & MOTIVATIONS
- Maintain a High Distinction academic average despite extremely limited energy slots.
- Successfully advocate for neurodivergent and carer communities at the university level.
- Manage complex caregiving duties for their mother without sacrificing their Honours research.
- Secure a PhD scholarship in Disability Studies to influence policy from within the system.

BEHAVIOURS
- Relies on strict, militant "time-blocking" to juggle uni, work, and caregiving.
- Prefers asynchronous, text-based communication over unpredictable live phone calls due to sensory load.
- Completes heavyweight academic drafting in hospital waiting rooms or during brief quiet periods at night.
- Uses "body doubling" apps and focus timers to stay on task during brain-fog episodes.
- Audits every new software tool for keyboard accessibility and dark-mode support before adoption.

PAIN POINTS
- Bureaucratic red tape: Navigating rigid university extension policies vs. unpredictable NDIS/carer crises.
- Cognitive fatigue from constantly having to self-advocate for basic accessibility accommodations.
- Severe burnout when group-mates fail to respect highly structured, pre-planned meeting times.
- Financial anxiety due to the unreliable nature of government support payments and medical costs.

TOOLS & TECH
Notion | Google Calendar | Slack | Zotero | LiquidText

CORE VALUES & ADVOCACY
- **Intersectionality:** Ensuring advocacy includes the most marginalised voices in the community.
- **Transparency:** Pushing for open, clear, and honest communication from institutional portals.
- **Autonomy:** Designing systems that empower users to manage their own needs without friction.

ACCESSIBILITY REQUIREMENTS
- High contrast text for reading in brightly lit hospital environments.
- Logical heading structures for screen reader compatibility during high-fatigue periods.
- Predictable interaction patterns to reduce cognitive load during multi-tasking.